Consider the expression $2x+3$, which is obtained by multiplying the variable x with the constant 2 and then adding the constant 3 to the product.

This expression is binomial as it contains two terms. The term $2x$ is a variable term and 3 is a constant term. 2 is the co-efficient of x.

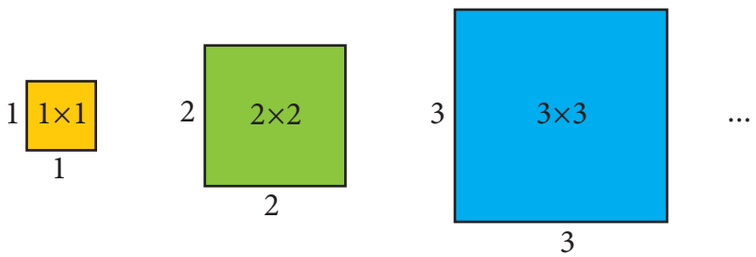
The terms with same variables are called like terms. For example, $-7x$, $2x$ and $5x$ are like terms. But, term with different variables are called unlike terms. For example, $-2x, 7y$ are unlike terms.

We can add or subtract like terms only. We know that $2x+5x=7x$. But, when we add unlike terms, it results in new expression. For example, $2x$ and $5y$ are unlike terms, thus resulting in new expression $2x+5y$.

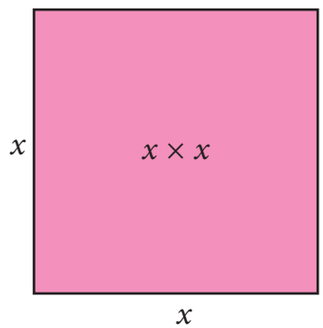
3.5.2 Degree of Expressions

To know the degree of an expression, first let us try to understand the degree of a variable by relating it with the exponents of numbers. Let us consider the square numbers. They have different base and same exponents.

The geometrical representation of square numbers are given below.



In general, if we consider the side of a square as a variable 'x' then its area will be $x \times x$ *sq. units*. This can be denoted as 'x^2'. Thus we have an algebraic expression with exponent notation.



If we consider the term x^2 as a monomial expression, the highest power of the expression is its exponent, that is 2.

Similarly, when length 'l' units and breadth 'b' units are variables of a rectangle, then its area is $l \times b = lb$ sq. units. We can consider lb as a term in an algebraic expression, where l and b are factors of lb.

The highest power of the expression lb is also 2, as we have to add up the powers of the variable factors.

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